

Caliber Collision

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Automotive Services (Collision Repair)
Revenue	\$7.5B
Employees	30,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	80

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Caliber Collision Centers
Headquarters	Lewisville, Texas
Founded	1997
Ownership	Private, PE-backed by Hellman & Friedman (since 2019 merger with ABRA Auto Body). IPO filed with SEC in 2024.
Footprint	1,700+ collision repair centers across 41 states. Largest U.S. collision repair company. Operations span urban, suburban, and rural markets.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Caliber Collision is the nation's largest auto collision repair company, operating 1,700+ repair centers across 41 states with approximately 30,000 employees. Backed by Hellman & Friedman, the company was formed through the 2019 merger of Caliber and ABRA Auto Body and has continued to grow through hundreds of acquisitions. Caliber filed for an IPO in 2024, signaling a transition from PE-backed growth to public-company operations.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Caliber Collision's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue ~\$7.5B [INFERRED from industry reports]. Created through merger of Caliber and ABRA Auto Body (2019) plus hundreds of subsequent acquisitions. Industry leader by revenue and location count. IPO filing suggests strong financial trajectory. Key pressure: labor shortages (collision repair technicians), rising parts costs, insurance reimbursement negotiations. Key tailwind: aging vehicle fleet and ADAS complexity driving repair values higher.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Mark Sanders - Chief Executive Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Led Caliber through ABRA merger and massive expansion. Former ABRA CEO.

Outreach rationale: Leading the PE-to-public transition. Economic buyer who understands the organizational maturity required for IPO.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Hellman & Friedman Partner - Board Representative

H&F manages ~\$100B in assets. Deep PE operating expertise.

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Caliber Collision operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Regional management structure with Area and Regional Vice Presidents overseeing clusters of centers. Heavy standardization of repair processes (Caliber Operating System). Technician-level operations are highly process-driven; management layer handles insurance relationships and workforce development.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor reviews show split: corporate and management roles generally positive on growth and opportunity; technician-level reviews frequently cite production pressure, understaffing, and disconnect between corporate values and shop-floor reality. The ABRA merger (2019) created lasting cultural friction in some markets where legacy ABRA employees felt absorbed rather than integrated. IPO preparation is adding compliance and process layers that long-tenured operators resist.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Caliber Collision.

1. 2024-12-01 - IPO filing with SEC (S-1 registration)

PE-to-public transition requires organizational maturity and governance readiness

2. 2025-03-01 - Continued acquisition pace despite IPO preparations

Growth hasn't slowed - integration debt continues to accumulate

3. 2025-06-01 - Technician shortage reaching critical levels industry-wide

Workforce retention and culture become strategic imperatives

4. 2025-09-01 - Insurance industry pushing back on reimbursement rates

Margin pressure intensifies need for operational excellence

5. 2025-01-01 - Legacy ABRA integration still showing cultural friction in some regions

Six years post-merger, culture gaps persist - signals deeper organizational issue

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Active IPO trigger, clear buyer (CEO), H&F budget, 1,700+ locations needing unified culture, technician retention crisis creates urgency. McChrystal's distributed operations expertise is directly applicable.

Primary Problem

Transitioning from a PE-backed growth machine to a public-ready organization while still integrating hundreds of acquisitions and managing a severe technician labor shortage.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Organizational design + leadership development. Caliber needs to professionalize its management layer to meet public-company standards while keeping frontline culture strong enough to retain scarce technicians.

Likely Objections to Engagement

IPO timeline may create urgency that favors tactical fixes over deep organizational work

Collision repair industry may seem 'too blue collar' for McChrystal - need to frame as distributed operations leadership

H&F may push back on advisory spend during IPO cost management phase

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey Operations practice

AlixPartners (PE advisory)

Bain PE practice

Korn Ferry (leadership assessment for IPO readiness)

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. Going public will put a spotlight on everything. Six years after the ABRA merger, where do you still feel like two companies rather than one?

Honest assessment of integration debt before IPO scrutiny reveals it.

2. You're losing technicians to independent shops that offer more autonomy. How do you compete for talent when you're also adding corporate governance for the IPO?

Tension between process (IPO-ready) and culture (technician-friendly).

Recommended Meeting Framing

Caliber is running 1,700 distributed operations that need to perform like one company under public-market

scrutiny. McChrystal built a system that made distributed teams perform at the highest level - the principles transfer directly from special operations to collision repair centers.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Caliber Collision's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing: Caliber Collision is the largest U.S. collision repair chain with 1,800+ locations, processing millions of vehicle repairs annually. The brand is built on insurance carrier relationships (State Farm, Geico, Progressive are key partners) and consistent repair quality. Caliber competes against Service King (now merged), Crash Champions, Gerber Collision, and thousands of independent shops.

Brand Identity Evolution: Caliber grew through aggressive PE-backed acquisition (Hellman & Friedman, then OMERS) from a regional chain to national dominance. The brand evolved from "quality local collision repair" to "national collision repair platform" - but the transition to potential IPO readiness requires further brand elevation toward institutional quality, compliance, and governance.

Marketing Leadership & Strategy: B2B marketing targeting insurance carrier partnerships (Caliber's primary referral source) and B2C marketing for walk-in customers. Insurance partnerships are the business - carrier satisfaction drives location volume. Brand reputation in insurance industry is more important than consumer brand awareness.

Brand Threats: Technician shortage is the existential operational threat - unfilled repair bays mean lost revenue. Electric vehicle complexity changing repair requirements (new skills, new equipment, new certifications). Advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS) calibration requirements add repair complexity. Independent shops fighting back through networks and co-ops.

McChrystal Connection: 1,800 locations, 30,000 employees, hundreds of acquisitions, insurance carrier SLA commitments, technician shortage - this is a distributed operations challenge at massive scale. Caliber's brand promise of consistent repair quality depends on organizational coordination ensuring every location delivers the same standard despite different legacy ownership, technician skill levels, and equipment.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Caliber Collision. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: PE-to-Public Organizational Maturation

Transitioning from PE-backed growth machine to IPO-ready organization requires building governance, compliance, process discipline, and reporting capabilities that private companies don't need. McChrystal builds the operating discipline that institutional investors expect without slowing the operational velocity that made Caliber successful under PE. EY/Deloitte handle SOX compliance; McChrystal builds the organizational maturity beneath it.

Fit Dimension 2: 1,800-Location Quality Consistency

Insurance carriers demand consistent repair quality and cycle time across all locations - any inconsistency triggers carrier audits and potential referral reduction. McChrystal's distributed operations model ensures 1,800 locations deliver consistent quality despite different acquisition vintages, technician skill levels, and local market dynamics.

Fit Dimension 3: Technician Workforce Crisis as Organizational Challenge

30,000 employees with severe technician shortages. The organizational response - recruiting, training, retention, career pathing - requires cross-functional coordination between HR, operations, training, and local management. McChrystal's operating model connects corporate workforce strategy to local execution.

9b. Cumulative Case

Caliber is the largest collision repair platform facing simultaneous scaling, IPO preparation, and technician shortage. Signal chain: 1,800+ locations -> PE ownership -> IPO preparation -> technician shortage -> insurance carrier SLA pressure -> EV/ADAS complexity -> need for organizational maturation. Revenue potential: \$350K initial, \$800K-\$1.2M deployment, \$300K ongoing. Total: \$1.5M-\$2M.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. IPO Readiness Gap: PE-era operational processes (informal, speed-first) must be formalized for public market scrutiny without losing agility. 2. Technician Shortage: Unfilled bays mean lost revenue and longer cycle times, which triggers insurance carrier penalties. The shortage is structural (declining interest in trades) not cyclical. 3. Acquisition Integration Backlog: Hundreds of acquisitions at different integration stages. Quality variation between fully integrated and newly acquired locations creates inconsistency. 4. EV/ADAS Complexity: Electric vehicles and advanced driver assistance systems require new technician skills, equipment, and certifications. Organizational readiness for this technology shift varies across locations. 5. Insurance Carrier Concentration: Top 3-5 carriers drive the majority of referral volume. Any carrier dissatisfaction has outsized revenue impact.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. IPO-Ready Operating Discipline: Governance and process framework meeting institutional investor expectations. Measurable: IPO readiness assessment scores improving quarterly. 2. Quality Consistency: 1,800-location quality coordination system. Measurable: insurance carrier satisfaction scores equalized across all locations. 3. Technician Pipeline: Cross-functional recruiting and retention program. Measurable: technician vacancy rate reduced by 20%. 4. EV/ADAS Readiness: Organizational preparation for technology transition. Measurable: EV-certified locations reaching 50% of network within 12 months.

9e. Key Stakeholders

CEO

Leader: [CEO]
Role: IPO readiness, enterprise strategy
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

COO

Leader: [COO]
Role: 1,800 location operations
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Quality consistency

CHRO

Leader: [CHRO]
Role: Technician recruitment/retention
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Workforce crisis

CFO

Leader: [CFO]
Role: IPO preparation, PE reporting
McChrystal Relevance: Financial governance

PE Sponsor

Leader: OMERS / Hellman & Friedman
Role: Value creation, exit planning
McChrystal Relevance: Sponsor relationship

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: IPO preparation creates urgency for organizational maturation. Technician shortage is worsening. EV/ADAS transition adds complexity. All converging within 12-18 month IPO timeline.

Why McChrystal: 1,800-location distributed operations + IPO organizational maturation + workforce crisis. McChrystal builds the operating discipline public markets expect while maintaining the operational speed PE ownership cultivated.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (\$300K-\$400K): IPO readiness + quality consistency framework. Phase 2 (\$500K-\$800K): Enterprise deployment, technician pipeline coordination. Phase 3 (\$300K retainer): Through IPO and stabilization. Total: \$1.1M-\$1.5M.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit: COO (quality operations), CHRO (technician crisis), PE sponsor (IPO readiness).